

**Department of Chemical and Biological
Science and Engineering**
Course Director's Handbook



February 2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Roles and Responsibilities.....	1
I. Semester BEFORE You Teach the Course	1
1. Administrative	1
2. Review Course Assessment Package	1
3. Department Curriculum and Assessment Committee	2
4. Textbook Review, Selection, and Ordering	3
5. Course Schedule	4
6. Room and Laboratory Assignment	4
7. Print Plant and Bulk Materials.....	5
8. Major Graded Event Schedule.....	5
9. Course Websites	5
II. Semester DURING Which You Teach the Course	6
1. Administrative	6
2. Assigning Assistant Course Director Authorization.....	6
3. Classroom and Related Departmental Procedures	6
4. Honor.....	7
5. Grading Philosophy and Grading Policies	8
6. Synchronizing Courses With More Than One Instructor.....	8
7. Quizzes, WPRs, and TEEs.....	9
8. Timeliness of Grading and Feedback to Cadets.....	10
9. Generative AI Policies	11
10. Risk Assessments for Laboratory Exercises.....	11
11. Grades and Grades Briefs	12
12. Class Rosters	13
13. Attendance Reporting.....	13
14. Substitute Instructors.....	13
15. Educational Trips.....	14
16. Guest Lectures.....	14
17. Evening Lecture Period.....	14
III. Immediately AFTER (within 30 days) You Teach the Course	14
1. End-of-Semester Archival Requirements	14
2. Course Assessment	15
Enclosure 1: Course Assessment Procedures	16
Enclosure 2: Example Grades Brief Format (large course).....	22
Enclosure 3: Example Grades Brief Format (small course).....	23

Roles and Responsibilities

Program Director - Senior faculty member responsible for the leadership and administration of a program within the Department of Chemical and Biological Science and Engineering (Chemistry, Biology, Chemical Engineering, Research/Center for Molecular Science, or Laboratory).

Course Supervisor - Senior faculty member designated by the Program Director to provide supervision, guidance, and leadership to a Course Director. Course Supervisor duties include, but are not limited to, course development, syllabus development, course change management, graded event revision/approval, and teaching/pedagogy mentorship.

Course Director - Faculty member assigned by a Program Director to provide direct leadership, administration, and development of an academic course within the Department of Chemical and Biological Science and Engineering.

I. Semester BEFORE You Teach the Course

1. Administrative

Upon your designation as a Course Director, you will be given access to the course in the Academy Management System (AMS) and Canvas for the specific semester(s) (NOTE: you need to designate the appropriate semester on the AMS logon screen to see your access). The department Administrative Officer/Executive Officer (Admin Off/XO) is the point of contact for ensuring that you are designated in AMS and Canvas. If you do not see your course in your AMS account after you have been designated Course Director, contact the Admin Off/XO to request access. You will need this access for information to complete other requirements.

The Department Head will be designated in Canvas as an Assistant Course Director for all courses to enable access to course grades and administrative data. Additionally, at least one other person within your program, to include the Course Supervisor, will also be designated as an Assistant Course Director. These designations are made so that at least one other person has access to your course in case of your absence.

2. Review Course Assessment Package

Every course is required to have a course assessment package once a year, per Enclosure 1 of this handbook. As with other AARs, this should be the starting point for new or returning Course Directors. The course assessment package ought to be reviewed, but, in particular, the Recommended Changes portion of the course assessment should be reviewed early in the preceding semester to identify any changes that may require significant time to implement.

Changes to a course do not need to be associated only with the official course assessment. However, significant changes to content should be made as part of a

deliberate decision process for course improvement that is documented within the course archives and assessment based. All proposed changes to courses will be briefed and approved during the course/program brief in the semester preceding the semester of execution.

3. Department Curriculum and Assessment Committee

The Department Head, with Program and Department leadership in attendance, will receive course briefings from all courses within a program at a time coordinated by the Program Director near the middle of the semester before you teach the course (April and October).

The emphasis of the program/course briefings is on assessment and improvement of the courses (items c and d below) and the program as a whole. Changes, both minor and major, should, in general, be in response to some assessment and address a perceived shortcoming in the course. Discuss planned changes with the Course Supervisor to consider institutional knowledge and overall fit within the program.

Significant changes to course content or conduct will be pre-coordinated among appropriate course stakeholders (e.g., other programs or courses for which the course is an elective or prerequisite) and briefed through the Program Director to the Department Head before significant time is spent on planning or administration. For these changes, the course/program briefing to the Department Head will be considered a final approval for execution.

In consultation with the Deputy Head, Program Directors will provide an appropriate format for the briefing. The course briefing will include:

- a. The current course description from the Redbook.
- b. Textbook selected.
- c. Summary/review of recommended changes and implementation from previous year's Course Assessment packet.
- d. Any proposed major changes and estimated cost from the previous year and the assessment-based reasons for the proposed change.
- e. Course schedule to include lessons and labs.
- f. Periods not used and drops. Periods not used are that portion of the scheduled class/lab periods that are not used for your course.
- g. Grading scheme: The number of points per event and total number of points for the course. Also delineate how many points constitute individually assigned points vs group work as a percentage.
- h. Number of quizzes, WPRs, and other major graded events.
- i. Task Organization: who will teach when and where.
- j. Substitute instructor plan.
- k. Any special requirements needed to make your course better such as trip sections, guest lectures, etc.

4. Textbook Review, Selection, and Ordering

The Operations Officer (OpsO) is the primary point of contact on all issues related to textbook assignment or purchasing.

The Program Director must approve your textbook selection and it will be briefed and approved during the course/program brief in conjunction with paragraph I.3 of this document.

If a change to the course textbook is indicated, you are encouraged to review several current textbooks and select the “best” book for your course, your instructors, and the cadets. You may call publishing companies to inquire about the most recent edition of texts. You MAY NOT discuss prices or enter into any agreements with companies. However, any company may send you a complimentary copy of a textbook to review as long as this is a normal business practice that is available to all their customers.

Electronic texts: The Academy and the Department do not have a universal policy on electronic texts. Some traditional publishers and texts are available with electronic copies or other electronic supplemental material. Some cadets are adept with e-texts and can take notes in that format. Others are not comfortable with that approach. Course Directors are responsible for clearly explaining to cadets whether electronic and/or hard-copy versions of the text are required or acceptable. Regardless, cadets are responsible for understanding the copyright and honor issues associated with sharing or copying e-texts or hardcopy. [Dean Memorandum for All USMA Cadets and Faculty, Subject: eBook Guidance for AY18]

The following textbook and solution manual requirements should be used as a general guide:

	<u>Textbook</u>	<u>Solutions Manual</u>
Cadet textbooks	1 per cadet	N/A
Instructors	1 per instructor	1 per instructor
Course Supervisor	1	1
Center for Enhanced Performance	1 (CH101/102/275 and CH151/2 only)	

You will submit your textbook requirements for cadets directly to the [Barnes & Noble College](#) website. The OpsO will send out a reminder when it is time to submit textbook requirements for the next semester (April for fall and STAP, October for spring). The projected enrollment for your course is found through AMS. [NOTE: the department currently teaches only CH101 during STAP. Unless otherwise specifically changed, the course material for STAP is assumed to be the same as for the Spring semester.]

If you do not receive complimentary textbooks for instructors from the publisher, you must request the use of departmental funds to purchase these textbooks. These orders can

be placed through the [Department Logistics Sharepoint](#) page. All textbook orders must include the ISBN, author's name, and edition for the book.

Laboratory materials for your course should be purchased as soon as they have been identified (unless they have a shelf-life which precludes this). A minimum of 30 days lead time is needed for the laboratory staff to request and receive the order, especially for bulk items. Because the end of the fiscal year (FY) is normally accompanied by disruptions in purchasing capabilities, this is particularly critical for fall-semester courses. Your Program Director has the POCs for purchasing laboratory supplies and they can be found on the [Department Logistics Sharepoint](#) page. The suspense for requesting lab materials for courses in the Spring and Fall semesters are 1 December and 1 July, respectively.

5. Course Schedule

First-time Course Directors will review [DPOM 02-03](#) (Classroom and Related Departmental Procedures) and [DPOM 02-08](#) (Academic Administration) in their entirety.

Review the Academic Program Redbook (electronic copy available via AMS <https://courses.westpoint.edu/static/index.htm>) to make sure that you understand how many lessons and labs are supposed to be taught. You must follow these and all course requirements shown in the Redbook. YOU MAY **NOT** EXCEED THE NUMBER OF LESSONS, LABS, OR REQUIREMENTS LISTED IN THE REDBOOK. For example, the current Academy schedule has 10 laboratory periods assigned via the RST/UVW system. If a course description allots only 7 labs in a semester, only 7 of these 10 periods may be used. The Course Director, however, has discretion on which of the 10 are assigned periods and which will be drops. The requirements should also fall within the parameters listed in DPOM 02-8, paragraphs 4j and 6b. There will be at least one class meeting each academic week of the semester (drops will not be scheduled to give an entire week off from class).

Review the previous year's schedule and the current Buff Card (AMS). The new semester's schedule should make sense when matched with the Academy schedule. Weeks with significant cadet time requirements or expected absences (e.g., 3-day weekends, Navy weekend, Thanksgiving, etc.) should be taken into account when scheduling WPRs. Consult the Academy schedule and your Course Supervisor to deconflict your major graded events with important Academy events.

Course Directors will consider grading time as they schedule graded events in their course. When feedback or AI on a quiz will be useful to cadets before they take the next quiz or WPR, Course Directors will plan enough time between events for faculty to grade and return quizzes to cadets. Similar planning applies to labs, presentations, problem sets, and other assignments.

6. Room and Laboratory Assignment

Courses are generally taught in the same classrooms and during the same hours on a recurring basis. This prevents the majority of course conflicts. Requested changes to

hours or classrooms need to be coordinated well in advance (1 March, for fall semester, 1 October for spring).

Discuss with the OpsO where and when you want to teach the lessons and labs. Some courses require certain classrooms and labs due to the nature of the course content. Special requirements, such as enhanced audio-visual and computer lab/classrooms, should be coordinated early in the planning cycle. Additionally, lower enrollment courses are usually taught in the smaller classrooms.

Course Directors may be contacted directly by the Registrar's office to deconflict schedules. Please keep Program and Department leadership informed when these situations arise.

7. Print Plant and Bulk Materials

For the most part, courses are responsible for reproducing hard copy materials needed for the course using department resources (copiers and paper). Unusually large reproductions may be requested through the USMA Print Plant. This is not a free service. Any requests must be completed and submitted to the Print Plant for reproduction o/a 1 July and 1 November for respective upcoming semesters. This will require coordination with the Admin Off/XO and admin staff. Remember that you must get permission from the publisher, in writing, if you want to reproduce information from textbooks.

8. Major Graded Event Schedule

In order to help deconflict rooms and limit the number of simultaneous major graded events for cadets in particular courses ("Thayer weeks"), you must submit your proposed WPR schedule to the OpsO o/a early-June and early-October. For courses with plebes and yearlings, you must identify how many cadets will take the WPR on each day, whether the WPR will be given during normal class hours or during the Dean's Hour, and if during Dean's Hour how many classrooms are needed. Exact dates for this requirement will be provided by the OpsO. These proposed WPR dates for core courses are consolidated and de-conflicted at the O/Dean for courses outside the Department. In general, larger enrollment courses get priority for WPR dates. You may be instructed to change your WPR dates based on this priority.

For courses in our majors, the OpsO will consolidate major graded events and forward to the Program Directors. Program Directors will look for conflicts within their program and between programs such as CH363/CH375/CH383. Program Directors will confer with Course Supervisors and Course Directors to minimize conflicts or develop contingency plans.

9. Course Websites

All courses will have a cadet-accessible electronic site on Canvas. Per paragraph II.5 of this document, documents that cadets should not have access to, including graded

events that have not been administered, will not be stored electronically on any website to which cadets have access. Even with restricted permissions, a chance of inadvertent release is possible.

For courses taught only during one semester, the Course Director may begin updating the websites at any point during the preceding semester. At a minimum, the course website must be current prior to the distribution of the Standing Instructions for Students (SIS) memorandum at the beginning of the semester. The URL for the applicable website will be included in the SIS and SIS documents for CH101/151, CH102/152, and CH275 require Department Head approval prior to distribution and execution.

The CLS IT support can help with administrative issues for websites (permissions, etc.). For help with website design, see your Course Supervisor.

II. Semester DURING Which You Teach the Course.

1. Administrative

All material to be given to cadets must be reviewed and approved by the Course Supervisor and/or Program Director prior to reproduction and distribution. This ensures correctness of all documents sent out by the Department.

2. Assigning Assistant Course Director Authorization

All courses will authorize the Department Head and at least one other member of the program, to include the Course Supervisor, as assistant Course Directors in AMS. This will allow for access to reporting attendance and grades if the Course Director is not available, as well as giving the Department Head access to 6-, 10-, and 15-week grades if an in-person briefing is not conducted.

3. Classroom and Related Departmental Procedures

a. The exemption from grading policy is clearly defined in DPOM 02-03. The exact nature of each of these policies is different and all Course Directors and instructors need to be familiar with the particular references. DPOM 02-03 covers the following exemptions:

- (1) Medical reasons
- (2) Corps Squad participation
- (3) Extracurricular activities and clubs
- (4) Honor investigation hearings

b. Additional Instruction is departmental course instruction supplemental to that which is presented during normal class time as scheduled in the course syllabus. BH330 is designated as the Department's Additional Instruction Room. All Cadets, CLS instructors, and courses are authorized to use this room at any time.

c. Food and gum are not authorized in classrooms at any time [DPOM 02-03]. The Department Head has designated all department classrooms equipped with a demonstration bench as laboratories. Food and drink are **NOT** authorized in these classrooms at any time. Gum chewing is also prohibited.

d. When in doubt, consult the DPOMs or your Course Supervisor!

4. Honor

a. If you or one of your instructors directly observes a Cadet using an unauthorized reference or device during a graded event, the following steps should be taken IMMEDIATELY!

- (1) If possible, take a photo of the incident or have another instructor corroborate the incident, as it is happening.
- (2) Stop the graded event for the Cadet observed using the unauthorized reference or device and take all graded event materials from the Cadet in question.
- (3) If the Cadet used an unauthorized device, ask the Cadet to show you the content on the device. (You cannot force the Cadet to show you.)
- (4) Inform the Cadet with another faculty or staff member observing that you will notify the Cadet Honor Committee.
- (5) Contact the Department Admin Officer/XO.
- (6) Both the instructor and the observer complete a DA2823 to document the events and submit to the Department Admin Officer/XO.
- (7) Input a grade of zero points for the graded event for the Cadet in question.

b. If you or one of your instructors suspects an honor violation, the following steps should be taken IMMEDIATELY!

- (1) Inform the Department Admin Off/XO, Course Director, and the Course Supervisor.
- (2) The Department Admin Off/XO will link you up with one of the Department's Cadet Honor Liaisons for further guidance on conducting an approach for clarification (normally within 24 hours). Only after these arrangements have been made will an approach for clarification be conducted.

5. Grading Philosophy and Grading Policies (from the Redbook, Part 1 - The Academic Program)

“Grading Philosophy

The foundation of USMA faculty’s grading philosophy is a commitment to evaluate cadets based on their achievement of announced course outcomes. Satisfactory performance on graded course requirements must therefore reflect satisfactory progress toward meeting course outcomes. USMA faculty establish reasonable academic standards of achievement in advance of cadets taking a course and taking tests. Their goal is not to rank order cadets against each other based on any preconceived concept of an appropriate grade distribution (curving). Instead, they challenge cadets to meet announced standards of performance and assign grades based on their success in doing so. The principal responsibility for academic performance rests with each individual cadet.

Grading Policies

- Instructors are responsible for providing sound instruction, measurement of cadet attainment, and a reasonable amount of additional assistance. Instructors shall strive to motivate and inspire cadets to achieve their full academic potential. Beyond these obligations, the responsibility for academic success or failure rests with each cadet.
- Instructors will provide cadets with a statement of the outcomes for each course. Cadets will be evaluated against these outcomes. Departments will avoid evaluation and grading practices that encourage reliance on curving.
- However, compiled numerically, letter grades ranging from A+ to F will be the standard means of communicating academic achievement.
- Instructors will promptly provide cadets an evaluation of each graded course requirement; the evaluation will be a letter grade or a numerical score easily convertible by the cadet to a letter grade.”

6. Synchronizing Courses with More than One Instructor

When a course has more than one instructor, the Course Director will provide a mechanism beyond lesson assignments to synchronize sections. Some learning objectives are more important than others, and faculty may emphasize material that is most relevant or interesting. Strategies to synchronize sections will depend on the number of faculty and their experience with the course. Large courses such as CH101 have Notes for Instructors (NFI). Other options might include short conversations between faculty, observing the Course Director’s class, or reviewing the Course Director’s lesson notes.

Whatever the methodology, the outcome of synchronization is that all cadets in any section are equally prepared for graded events, informed of upcoming events, aware of lab safety hazards. Topics of synchronization can include:

- a. Distinguishing essential learning objectives from enrichment or broadening objectives. A content map of the course that shows how concepts in early lessons support subsequent lessons may be helpful for faculty teaching a course for the first time.
- b. Coordination for grading suspenses, pre-briefs, or other administration. Faculty teaching multiple courses or with significant non-teaching responsibilities often depend on the Course Director to help them anticipate upcoming events.
- c. Common misconceptions or trouble spots for cadets, ideally with potential strategies to help cadets overcome obstacles.
- d. Possible demos or other resources to enrich lessons.
- e. Safety risks, specific skills, waste disposal, or other coordination for labs.

7. Quizzes, Written Partial Reviews (WPRs) and Term-End Examinations (TEEs)

The Course Supervisor must review all quizzes, WPRs, labs, writing assignments, and TEE materials. Following Course Supervisor approval, all CH101/151, CH102, and CH275 WPRs and TEE will be reviewed/approved by the Department Head prior to administering, so ensure ample time is allowed for this process. Course Directors will ensure timely preparation of graded event materials. Blank versions of the graded event, draft solutions, and draft cut scales will be submitted to the Course Supervisor NLT two weeks prior to the scheduled date for administration. All graded event materials will be prepared as different versions for each instance of administration. WPRs administered in different hours usually require distinct versions for each hour.

After an examination is written it will be rigorously edited. This is necessary to ensure correct English usage and conformance to established format. Spelling, punctuation, and readability should be checked carefully.

All test questions should be written in the simplest, most unambiguous language possible. Check for instructor blind spots in vocabulary or assumptions. For example, cadets from warm places may not know that ice forms at 32°F. Verify that jargon matches the terms used in the course textbook or the learning objectives. Remember, if cadets incorrectly respond to a question, it should be because they do not know the answer, not because they do not understand the question.

All WPRs and TEEs will include the following information on the [front cover sheet](#): 1) date of exam; 2) time allowed for the exam; 3) points for each section and total number of points; 4) references authorized for use during the exam; and 5) what material is covered by the exam (i.e., chapters covered), to include the name/edition of the textbook and lab manual (if appropriate). Also address when cadets may discuss the graded event with each other. The requirement from DPOM 02-03 is:

“Course directors should include the following statement on all exams:

'This WPR (or quiz, writ, or TEE) will be released from academic security _____'. Prior to that time, I may not discuss any aspects of this exam with anyone except an XX### instructor.' This statement will include a blank for cadets to fill in the conditions for release from academic security. e.g. a specific date-time group or 'once exams are returned'.

This policy does not preclude an instructor from allowing cadets to talk about the test immediately following the exam. In that case the blank could be filled with 'immediately following 'Cease Work"' or 'upon turn-in of the individual exam'"

All hard copies of quizzes, WPRs and TEEs are considered "sensitive" items, will be transported in orange-colored folders only, and MUST be secured in a locked cabinet or in the department safe until returned to the cadets. (TEEs are never returned.) Faculty will not review graded events, solutions, or cut scales when cadets are in the room.

A digital folder under the "[Courses](#)" and "[Graded Events](#)" tabs on the department SharePoint site is available for Course Directors to use as a working location for course materials and graded events, respectively. Course directors will not email copies of restricted material. These files should be stored in the appropriate digital folder and the link can be distributed to other instructors. Copies of completed graded events may be kept in the "Graded Events" folder once the graded exams have been returned to cadets.

Each course will normally administer a TEE. However, there may be exceptions granted by the Head of the Department. TEEs will be administered only on the dates and times shown on the final TEE schedule. The Dean must approve any exception. All cadets enrolled in a course will take its scheduled TEE unless excused by the Dean. Make-up TEEs or changes to TEE scheduling will be coordinated through the Department OpsO to the O/Dean, Academic Affairs Division (AAD). Course Directors or cadets do not have the authority to schedule a makeup/ahead TEE – only AAD can authorize a cadet to take the exam at an alternate time. Course Directors will submit TEEs for approval to Course Supervisors NLT one month prior to the exam date.

8. Timeliness of Grading and Feedback to Cadets

Faculty will take accountability of submissions within one class day of the due date. Contact cadets immediately if submissions are missing. Courses have multiple modes and locations for cadets to submit work. The "missing" assignment may be in the "turn-in tower" in BH430 or in another instructor's inbox.

Submitted work should be graded within one week after submission. When this is impractical, return graded work to cadets in time for them to use that feedback and/or schedule AI before the next graded event is due.

If cadets have extended absences or profiles, schedule those cadets for a make-up event or work with your Course Supervisor to develop an individualized plan for those

cadets. Return graded events to other cadets so that they can review their work and schedule AI if necessary. You may delay posting solutions when that information would provide an unfair advantage to cadets taking makeup events.

9. Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policies

Guidance for course policies on generative artificial intelligence changes as the programs change and as we get more experience using them. In Fall 2023, courses were required to have a statement regarding use of generative AI in their Standing Instructions for Students. In Spring 2024, the statement was required on each individual assignment where cadets might use generative AI. Consider how cadets will be allowed to use generative AI on specific assignments in your course and be prepared to publicize that information as the Dean provides additional guidance to us.

An example statement from CH275 Standing Instructions for Students is below:

“Generative Artificial Intelligence (Generative AI). As outlined by the [DAAW](#), Cadets are allowed to use generative AI tools such as ChatGPT for specific assignments, as designated by the course director. However, for these specific assignments, students should follow the “verify everything” approach to the content generated by these AI tools. It is the student’s responsibility to check the original sources to be sure they are not plagiarizing work. **The use of generative AI is not allowed for any work associated with the SWE** as the purpose of the SWE is to provide evidence of your proficiency as a writer and a critical thinker. For the SWE, all submitted work must be produced by the Cadet and use of generative AI tools such as ChatGPT to complete the assignment constitutes a violation of the Honor Code.”

10. Risk Assessments for Laboratory Exercises.

Course Directors will perform a risk assessment for all laboratory exercises and demonstrations, prior to the execution of that exercise, and provide documentation with DD Form 2977. Computer laboratory exercises are exempt from this requirement. Prior to execution, each risk assessment that involves the use of chemicals will be approved by the appropriate Course Supervisor and reviewed by the Senior Chemist prior to being archived on the Department SharePoint page under [Safety](#). Risk assessments that involve biohazards will be reviewed by the Microbiologist after Course Supervisor approval and archived as described above. Any risk assessments that involve physical hazards (steam, high pressure, sharp objects) will be reviewed by the Safety Officer after Program Director approval and archived in the same manner as above. All risk assessments will be updated annually or when a lab procedure changes.

11. Grades and Grades Briefings

Course Directors will only ensure grades in Canvas are accurate at the 6 and 15-week mark to provide timely feedback to the cadets’ chain-of-command, while final grades will need to be physically “posted” in AMS. The 6-week and 15-week grades do not require

formal briefings to the Department Head, though any particularly notable grades (C- or below) should be explained to your Course Supervisor and Program Director. Additionally, Cadets with a C- or below at the 6, 10, or 15 week mark in the semester will be counseled in writing by their instructor and a neutral Cadet Observation Report (COR) will be submitted through AMS. The 10-week and final grades MUST first be briefed to your Course Supervisor and Program Director, then to the Head of the Department and approved BEFORE they are posted in AMS.

GRADES BRIEFINGS. Your 10-week and final grades briefings should include (at a minimum) percent of course completed, a grade summary with histogram (graph of the distribution of grades), average course QPA, how many cadets are failing the course and corrective actions in-place or planned, and the grade distribution compared with the previous year's grades. Briefing format emphasis should be on content, not presentation. See Enclosures 2 and 3 for formatting and additional guidance.

Although grades are entered into Canvas as graded events are completed, grades are sent electronically to the O/Dean using the AMS program. The Admin Off/XO will set up Course Director permissions for each course. Only Course Directors can post grades to AMS. Course Supervisors and Program Directors are experienced in AMS and grade reporting procedures, so do not hesitate to ask for help. When posting grades in the AMS, ensure points and averages are NOT visible to cadets. You will be asked to confirm this as part of the electronic posting process.

FINAL GRADES. Final grades are usually due 1-2 days after the end of TEE week. This means that all grades must be calculated, approved, and submitted in a timely manner. It is imperative that your grades be accurate and correctly reflect what the cadets have earned. Meticulous attention to detail must be the standard practice during this process. At least one instructor will review TEEs of cadets who fail a course. At a minimum, verify page totals and overall totals for accuracy. Courses with multiple instructors may choose to have a second instructor apply the cut scale to the work and assign a score. If exams are regraded, the goal is accuracy, not finding or cutting additional points to change a cadet's final grade in a course.

The final grades brief to the Department Head should include: grade summary with histogram, 15-week grades, last year's final grades, WPR and TEE scores, final histogram to include QPA, and suggested letter grades for cadets. Be prepared to brief any desired changes to standard grade cut-offs. All deficient cadets (failures and NC) must be identified to the Department Head during the final grades briefing and to the Admin Off/XO, along with an initial recommendation (separate, retain, repeat).

If a Cadet does not complete all assignments within the course, they will receive an NC until the work is complete and turned in, regardless of the grade awarded. Cadets are not obligated to use every attempt on every item in on-line assignments to meet this requirement.

All courses will back-up and retain an electronic copy of all course grades (alpha roster and OML, saved as a PDF, that includes all graded events, name, course points, course totals, percentage, and letter grade) for historical requirements prior to posting final grades.

Final grades will not be discussed with cadets, especially deficient cadets. No TEE scores or final averages will be provided to cadets. Cadets wishing to see their TEE will schedule an appointment with the Head of the Department. Course Directors and Supervisors will coordinate such meetings. TEEs will be stored by the Department until each July.

12. Class Roster(s).

Course Directors will be notified by Academic Affairs Division (AAD) when class rosters are available. Rosters may change throughout Reorg week and Add/Drop (until Lesson 3).

DO NOT add or delete cadets from these rosters unless directed to do so by the O/Dean or the Admin Off/XO.

13. Attendance Reporting

Every instructor will receive a report from the section marcher at the beginning of each class. The section marcher will annotate all absent, late, or early departing cadets on the section marcher roster.

Course Directors will ensure that all instructors enter their attendance reports in Canvas after class. Attendance reporting should reflect the actual status of the class attendance. If a cadet is absent from a class or lab, they will be reported as absent.

14. Substitute Instructors

Course Directors will brief their preliminary substitute instructor plan during the course brief to the Department Head during the previous semester. Requested absences of the instructor (e.g., to attend conferences, etc.) will include the specific substitute plan for any missed classes and as a professional courtesy, the plan to “pay back” the faculty member who substituted to facilitate the absence.

In the event of emergency absence or inclement weather, the substitute plan may include combining of classes, if sufficient substitutes are not available to maintain sectioning. It is NOT ACCEPTABLE to cancel class due to instructor absence, inclement weather, TDY, illness, etc., without prior Department Head approval.

15. Educational Trips

Educational trips provide academic instruction that is not available at the Academy but important to meet course objectives. Educational trips (mandatory or voluntary) are requested electronically through the Admin Off/XO to the Dean of the Academic Board using the Academic Trip/Event Request System on your Staff & Faculty Portal web page in AMS. Course Directors will input these requests at least 30 days in advance. All cadets projected to attend the trip must deconflict any WPRs, labs, or other major graded events that will be missed. This means they must coordinate with their instructors to make up any missed events. See the Admin Off/XO for questions concerning use of the automated trip request system. Educational trips are not authorized during the two weeks prior to Term End Week.

16. Guest Lectures

Guest Lectures can provide valuable depth to a particular subject and expose cadets to subject matter experts outside of the Academy. However, Course Directors need to be conscious of the regulatory and budgetary restrictions when considering inviting a guest lecturer. If government funds of any type (not just department funds) are to be used, then the Course Director must complete a TDY worksheet and submit it to the Administrative Staff. No firm offer can be extended to a lecturer until the TDY request and funding is routed and approved by the Department Head. If a lecturer is willing to come and cover all their own costs, a TDY worksheet still needs to be completed to place them on invitational orders (allows use of government travel/lodging rates, reserved parking, etc.). However, no guest or visitor can be invited to the department without prior approval of the Department Head on a visitor request form, regardless of funding needs. Course Directors must coordinate with the Administrative Officer for specifics on requesting, accounting for attendance, and follow up requirements, as well as for any special needs, such as being picked up at an airport or reserved parking in the CPA.

17. Evening Lecture Period

You may use the Evening Lecture Period for course-wide lectures. Any mandatory course meetings outside scheduled class or lab periods must be compensated with scheduled class time as close as possible to the lecture to meet the credit hour expectations outlined in the Redbook.

Evening lectures must be requested through the OpsO and approved by the O/Dean. Evening lectures are not authorized during the two weeks prior to Term End Week.

III. Immediately AFTER You Teach the Course.

1. End-of-Semester Archival Requirements

The Admin Off/XO will maintain a folder for each course under the secured “[Courses](#)” and “[Graded Events](#)” folder accessible through the Department SharePoint page.

Ensure the following course material is placed in the appropriate location as follows:

Course Folder:

- Two PDF rosters of final grades (alpha roster and OML, saved as a PDF, that includes all graded events, name, course points, course totals, percentage, and letter grade)
- Course Assessment Package (Enclosure 1)
- All course material (SIS, RDC, lesson schedule, labs, lesson assignments with lesson objectives, etc.)
- Interim grades (6, 10, 15-week interim grades and 10-week grade briefs)
- Any other relevant course material that will aid future CDs

Graded Events Folder:

All graded events, solutions, and cut scales (labs, quizzes, WPRs, TEE, capstone, etc.)

With exception of the course assessment, this must be complete within one (1) week after posting final grades for the semester. The Administrative Officer is responsible for ensuring the complete and timely digital submission of course materials.

2. Course Assessment: This is the most critical contribution a Course Director can make! Aspire to leave the course better than when you assumed duties as the Course Director. The Course Assessment Package is a complete record and comprehensive assessment of the entire course. This is the historical record of your course. Future Course Directors will use it to understand what you did and to guide future plans. It should be as complete as possible. This is also the basis for follow on discussions during course briefings (I.6). The course assessment process has four critical components:

- a. Any Course Director notes made during the semester, annotating portions that went particularly well or poorly.
- b. Faculty AAR. Ensure that you meet with all the instructors in the course, the Course Supervisor, and the Program Director to discuss what went well and what did not go well and ways to improve the course.
- c. Course Assessment Package (see Enclosure 1 and ensure you follow closely) – place **electronic copy** in your “[Courses](#)” folder (**within 30 days of posting final Grades**).

Enclosure 1

COURSE ASSESSMENT PROCEDURES

1. PURPOSE. The purpose of this enclosure is to provide a guideline of procedures for the annual assessment of courses.

2. GENERAL PHILOSOPHY

a. Course assessment is the process by which we systematically analyze how well a given course accomplishes its objectives and how effectively it contributes to respective Program Objectives. The principal goal of this process is to ensure that our courses remain rigorous, relevant, and well-integrated in their respective programs.

b. Because of the high rate of faculty turnover at USMA, course assessment also serves as an important means of maintaining *continuity* in our programs. As such, every course will have a formal assessment once per year for any academic year in which it is taught. Course Directors and Program leadership should strive to assess courses based on quantitative data from both internal and external assessment instruments. Assessment tools that compare Cadet performance to a nationwide average are a valuable element of meaningful assessment.

c. Effective course assessment considers all relevant data to identify *strengths* and *areas for improvement* in a given course. Where appropriate, these areas for improvement are used as the basis for well-coordinated changes to course objectives, course content, or course processes.

d. Effective course assessment is an *inclusive, collaborative process* in which all relevant stakeholders are given the opportunity to influence the future direction of the curriculum. To this end, Course Directors should provide a forum at the end of each semester of execution for all stakeholders, instructors, etc., to provide direct feedback on the execution of the course. This input should be captured and incorporated into the course assessment package.

e. Effective course assessment requires a substantial investment in time and energy. The benefits can (and should) be worth the investment; but such benefits are only realized if all participants approach the process with a willingness to (1) actively seek areas for improvement and (2) implement substantive changes to courses and curriculum, as appropriate.

3. COURSE ASSESSMENT PROCESS

a. Using the example format in this section, each course will draft the course assessment package immediately following the grading of TEEs. Course assessments will be reviewed and approved by program leadership and the Course Supervisor. Program

leadership will provide feedback and guidance to ensure courses are appropriately contributing to program outcomes.

b. Following program approval, course assessments will be placed in PDF format in the specific course folder on the Department SharePoint site (top under “courses”). Course Directors will also produce two grade reports (one by OML and one alphabetical) as part of the executive summary, saved as a PDF, that will be placed in the digital course folder on SharePoint. Reports will include all graded events, name, course points, course totals, percentage, and letter grade.

c. All course assessment documents will be digitally archived NLT 31 January for Fall Semester courses and NLT 15 June for Spring semester courses. Courses taught during both semesters may do a single course assessment for the entire year, due 15 June, but the grade reports annotated in the archival requirements must be furnished for each semester. Program leadership is responsible for ensuring that all documentation is archived prior to summer-cycle assignments or departures.

PAGE INTENTIONALLY LEFT BLANK

MEMORANDUM FOR RECORD

SUBJECT: CHXXX Course Assessment, AY YY-S

1. General Assessment (*In paragraph format, please answer the following questions*)
 - a. Were the course objectives achieved?
 - b. Do the course objectives cover the body of knowledge appropriately, and do the course objectives lend themselves to assessment?
 - c. Are course processes appropriate?
 - d. How does the course contribute to the program objectives?
2. Red Book Description: *List the current Redbook description.*
 - a. **Assessment:** *Does the red book description match what is taught in the course?*
 - b. **Recommendation:** *For changes, include a word document cut and paste Redbook entry and use "track changes" when submitting recommendation.*
3. **Enrollment** – *This AY and next AY (projected).*
 - a. **Assessment:** *How does the student population compare from one year to the other? Assess effect of population on course.*
 - b. **Recommendation:** *Discuss how changes in enrollment may affect budget, teaching style, facility requirements, etc.*
4. **Course Objectives** – *List course objectives here (from SIS).*
 - a. **Assessment:** *Were the course objectives achieved? Do the course objectives cover the body of knowledge appropriately? Do the course objectives lend themselves to assessment?*
 - (1) **Coverage** - *Indicate coverage of objectives by graded events.*
 - (2) **Performance** - *Indicate performance on course objectives.*
 - b. **Recommendations:** *Recommended changes to objectives.*
 - (1) **Coverage** - *Recommended changes to coverage of objectives by graded events.*
 - (2) **Performance** - *Recommendations to address shortcomings in performances on course objectives.*
5. **Course QPA** – *List course QPA here (available in AMS). Include numbers from the last six terms.*
 - a. **Assessment:** *Discuss any discernible trends or abrupt changes in course GPA over past several terms.*
 - b. **Recommendations** *to address any perceived problems.*
6. **TEE Grade** – *List course average TEE grade with standard deviation here from the last six terms.*

- a. **Assessment:** *Discuss any discernible trends or abrupt changes in TEE grade over past several terms.*
- b. **Recommendations** *to address concerns with TEE grades.*

7. Course Processes

- a. Textbook – *List current textbook – title, author, edition*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Is the current textbook appropriate?*
 - (2) **Recommended** *changes to the textbook*
- b. Course Content - *Abbreviated list of subjects or "lesson blocks" covered in the course (not the syllabus).*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Is the course content appropriate? Are the lesson blocks appropriate?*
 - (2) **Recommended** *changes to course content or lesson blocks.*
- c. Lessons and labs – *List of lessons and labs in the course (syllabus).*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Are the numbers of lessons and labs appropriate?*
 - (2) **Recommended** *changes to the number of lessons and labs.*
- d. Summary of Graded Requirements –
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Are the graded requirements appropriate?*
 - (2) **Recommended** *changes to the graded requirements.*
- e. Areas of Special Emphasis –
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Are the areas of special emphasis appropriate?*
 - (2) **Recommended** *changes to the areas of special emphasis.*
- f. Survey Questions - *Are the survey questions appropriate?*
 - (1) Survey Results – *Include analysis of Course-End Feedback or other surveys to include averages, standard deviations, number of responses, significant trends, suggestions or input that you believe should be incorporated into the course in the future.*
 - (2) Survey Freeform Comments - *Results of any free-form comments from cadets about the course – summarize the most prevalent positive and negative comments.*

8. Contribution to the Program Outcomes - *List program outcomes here.*

- a. Coverage - *Indicate coverage of program outcomes by graded events.*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Does the course contribute to the program outcomes? How?*
 - (2) **Recommendations** *to address shortcomings in coverage of outcomes.*
- b. Performance - *Indicate performance on program outcomes and provide*
recommendations *to address problems in performance on program outcomes.*

9. Resources and Laboratories Assessment

- a. Laboratories - *List laboratories or lab-based projects used in the course.*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Was equipment available for desired experiments? Was equipment working?*
- b. Computer Labs - *List computer labs used in the course.*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Were adequate computing facilities available for the course?*
- c. Physical Models & Demos - *List physical models and demos used in the course.*

- (1) **Assessment:** *Were physical models and demos adequate? In good working order?*
 - d. Technician Support - *List technician support used in this course (wet lab or IT).*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Was technician support adequate?*
 - e. Supplies - *List any wet lab or computer supplies used in this course.*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Were supplies adequate?*
 - f. Additional Facilities - *List any additional facilities used.*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *Were the additional facilities adequate?*
 - g. Unfunded Requests - *List any unfunded requests from last AY and whether or not they were funded.*
 - (1) **Assessment:** *If provided, were the items made available by the unfunded requirements adequate?*
 - (2) **Recommendations 9a – 9g** *to address any shortcomings or shortages in any resource or laboratory equipment.*
- 10. **Implementation of Recommendations from last AY** - *List recommendations from last year's course assessment and describe how they were implemented this AY. Assess whether implementation was Successful, Unsuccessful, or requires additional assessment. Include data, where applicable.*
- 11. The POC for this memorandum is LTC John Wayne and can be reached at 845-938-xxxx or john.wayne@westpoint.edu.

John Wayne, Ph.D.
LTC, Branch
Department of Chemical and Biological Science
and Engineering

****This is an example format focused on content. Final versions for the course will be published IAW AR 25-50.**

Enclosure 2

Final Grades Brief (small course)

(digital file provided on the CBSE Table of Contents)

Example Final Grades Brief (small course)

2024-2			2023-2			2022-2			2021-2			2020-2		
Name	Percent	Letter Grade	Name	Percent	Letter Grade	Name	Percent	Letter Grade	Name	Percent	Letter Grade	Name	Percent	Letter Grade
Cadet A	97.77	A+	Cadet 1A	98.14%	A+	Cadet 2A	97.58%	A+	Cadet 3A	97.67%	A+	Cadet 4A	98.67	A+
Cadet B	97.77	A+	Cadet 1B	98.05%	A+	Cadet 2B	97.58%	A+	Cadet 3B	97.67%	A+	Cadet 4B	96.61	A+
Cadet C	97.49	A+	Cadet 1C	98.05%	A+	Cadet 2C	97.12%	A+	Cadet 3C	96.74%	A+	Cadet 4C	96.36	A+
Cadet D	97.40	A+	Cadet 1D	97.40%	A+	Cadet 2D	97.12%	A+	Cadet 3D	96.74%	A+	Cadet 4D	93.74	A
Cadet E	96.37	A	Cadet 1E	97.30%	A+	Cadet 2E	95.81%	A	Cadet 3E	91.44%	A-	Cadet 4E	93.35	A
Cadet F	96.37	A	Cadet 1F	94.48%	A	Cadet 2F	95.81%	A				Cadet 4F	93.21	A
Cadet G	95.91	A	Cadet 1G	93.81%	A							Cadet 4G	92.88	A
Cadet H	95.35	A	Cadet 1H	93.33%	A									
Cadet I	95.16	A	Cadet 1I	90.05%	A-									
Cadet J	94.79	A	Cadet 1J	88.84%	B+									
Cadet K	91.91	A-												
Cadet L	91.72	A-												
Cadet M	91.44	A-												
Cadet N	91.26	A-												
Cadet O	91.16	A-												
Cadet P	89.77	B+												
Cadet Q	85.86	B												
Cadet R	85.67	B												
Cadet S	78.60	C+												

(digital file provided on the CBSE Table of Contents)

23